

Katerina Zinich

product designer

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I specialise in reducing cognitive load within high-stress environments by grounding product development in psychology and user evidence. From leading enterprise optimisations for high traffic retailers like Officeworks to distilling startup concepts into scalable MVPs at Navis Sideralis, I bridge the gap between business goals and technical execution. I am WCAG 2.2 certified and leverage AI to accelerate research, ensuring every product is inclusive, accessible, and commercially viable.

Technical Toolkit

- **Primary Design Tool:** Figma (Design Systems, Prototyping, Component Architecture)
- **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.2 Compliance, Screen Reader Testing, Colour Contrast Analysis, Inclusive Design Audit
- **AI-Enhanced Workflow:** Antigravity (Rapid Prototyping), LLMs for Thematic Research Clustering and Interview Scripting.
- **Creative Suite:** Adobe XD, Photoshop, Illustrator, Firefly
- **Analytics & Research:** Hotjar, Adobe Analytics, Google Lighthouse, SEMrush
- **Project Management:** Jira, Confluence, Monday (Agile Methodology)
- **Technical Knowledge:** HTML, CSS, and various CMS (Contentful, Shopify, Webflow)

Experience

Product Designer

Navis Sideralis | November 2025 – Present

I collaborate with startups to distil initial concepts into structured, scalable products. My focus is on grounding product development in user evidence and strategic roadmapping to ensure long-term growth.

- **Research and Strategy:** Conducted in-depth user interviews and research to identify core pain points and market opportunities.
- **MVP Definition:** Defined Minimum Viable Products by prioritising features that balance user needs with immediate business goals.
- **Design System Creation:** Built and documented scalable design systems from the ground up. This ensured visual consistency and provided a clear library for tech squads to accelerate development.

- **Implementation Roadmapping:** Developed detailed roadmaps for product implementation to ensure a clear path from design to launch.
- **Technical Integration:** Collaborated with developers to align design specifications with technical sprints, ensuring timely and high-quality releases.

Digital engagement designer (UX/UI)

Officeworks | Dec 2024 – Sep 2025

In this role for a high-traffic e-commerce platform, I turned user insights into measurable business results. I worked with cross-functional teams to ensure that complex digital projects remained user-friendly and technically feasible.

- **Stakeholder Partnership:** Engaged business and IT leads to translate high-level objectives into technical design artefacts, ensuring alignment across the product vision.
- **Data-Driven Iteration:** Used analytics and user feedback to refine front-end UI. This successfully reduced bounce rates and improved the customer journey during peak periods.
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Balanced usability with technical constraints alongside engineers and product leads to ensure seamless execution.
- **Process Efficiency:** Introduced pre-development UI validation workshops to catch issues early. This streamlined the handover process and led to faster decision-making.

UX/UI Designer (Freelance)

Various Clients | Sep 2019 – Dec 2024

I led end-to-end design projects for a range of clients. I focused on identifying pain points and developing innovative solutions that turned concepts into launch-ready products.

- **Product Strategy and MVP:** Partnered with startup founders to define product requirements, creating user journeys and core features that solved real user problems.
- **End-to-End Delivery:** Developed full-cycle deliverables, including interactive prototypes and high-fidelity visuals, to ensure an intuitive user experience.
- **Research and Validation:** Conducted user research to identify behaviours and motivations. I used these insights to validate design choices and improve user retention.
- **Scalable Design Systems:** Established and evolved design systems and brand guidelines to ensure consistency across products and smoother developer handoffs.

- **Commercial Impact:** Led design overhauls that directly supported business growth. This included achieving a 36% lift in seasonal campaign sales through improved UI.

Achievements

Vibe-a-thon

Archasangel | AWS | Vercel | Heidi | CDH | April 2026

First Prize Winner: Led the design of Springboard at the Cremorne Digital Hub hackathon. Developed an MVP solution to help highly skilled professionals secure short-term contracts, focusing on reducing friction in the hiring process.

Education

Institute of Modern Art
Bachelor of Arts

Animation Lyceum
Advanced Diploma of Arts

Liz Brown
WCAG 2.2 Web Accessibility